

1. We have no choice about
past facts.

2. In the past, God had foreknowledge of our future actions.

3. We have no choice about God's knowing that in the future I will perform a certain action. (1,2)





4. If we have no choice about some facts, and those facts necessitate X , we have no choice about X .



two
arguments
against free
will



is fate
real?



why
believe in
free will?



three
ways out

We can call this the No Choice/Necessitation Principle. Why think that this principle is true?

Suppose that you have no choice about whether some event A happens, and that it is necessary that if A happens, B happens. For you to have a choice about B , it seems like you must be able to break the connection between A and B -- to make it the case that even though A happens, B does not. But if it is necessary that if A happens, then B happens, that would be to do something **impossible**.

We can also consider examples. Suppose you now have no choice about the fact that you woke up at 10:15 yesterday morning. Could you nonetheless now have a choice about whether you got up before 11:00 yesterday? It seems not -- because you had no choice about the first fact, and it necessitates the second one.



1. We have no idea about

parasitiforms.



2. In the past, God had

for knowledge of future

acai.ios.



God's knowing that in

act in action (1,2)

the future I will perform

3. We have no idea about



4. If we have no idea about

some facts, and these facts

chicely abilitx.

need, since X , we have no

that Predict did not **take away** their free will; it just shows them that they

never had any. So they lacked free will before getting a Predict.

So now consider a possible scenario in which someone exactly like you would get

a Predictor. By the above line of thought, this person would lack free will. But

either.

But this person was stipulated to be exactly like you. So you don't have free will,

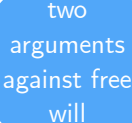
and the example of the Predictor — which seem to show that if there is such a

So far we've looked at two imaginary thought experiments—the story of Osmo,

things as fate, then there is no free will.

Our question is: do either fatigue or foreknowledge pose a

serious challenge to the reality of free will?



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freedom that comes from fate.

Our first topic today is the oldest challenge to the existence of free will: the challenge to

We'll shortly consider some ways of

responding to Edwards' argument. But

first let's think about how Edwards'

argument might be related to an argument

for fatalsn.

Edwards' argument — but did believe that

similar to Edwards' argument?

Suppose that someone did not believe in

God— and hence rejected premise (2) of

there were truths about all our future

actions. Could they give an argument

with reference to the being of truth about

replace reference to God's foreknowledge

our future actions.

(5) Let's look at what happens if we

God only shows up in premises (2) and



4. If we have no choice about p , and no

1. We have no direct facts.

5* We have noticed that the fact

2*In the past, there were truths about

perform a certain action (1,2)

all of our activities.



3 We have not at the fact that

choice about the fact that if p , then q ,

acaioid.

that if it is true that I will perform

will perform various actions.

(3, 4, 5)

0 We have achieved what we

then we have the choice about q.

some action, then I will prefer that

God knows that in the future I will

The fatalist argument



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